

Tricity, Poland

Tricity (Polish: *Trójmiasto*; Kashubian: *Trzëgård*; German: *Dreistadt*) is an urban area in Pomeranian Voivodeship, in northern Poland, primary consisting of the cities of Gdańsk, Gdynia, and Sopot on the shore of Gdańsk Bay. Inhabited by 960,000 people within the boundaries of the three cities, and approximately 1.09 million people across the surrounding metropolitan area, it is one of the principal urban areas of Poland and is home to several governmental institutions.

The concept of a singular Tricity metropolitan area first emerged following World War II, and the term is today widely used in several official and unofficial contexts.

Etymology and terminology

The Polish term *Trójmiasto* was first mentioned in the 1 February 1950 issue of *Dziennik Bałtycki*, within a headline regarding the integration of the three cities of Gdańsk, Sopot, and Gdynia.^[1] Tricity has also been referred to as the *Gdańsk metropolitan area* or the *Gdańsk agglomeration*.^{[2][3]}

History

The recorded history of Gdańsk, the oldest city in the Tricity area, goes back to as far as the year 997;^[4] Sopot was first mentioned in 1283,^[5] and Gdynia, although extant as a small village as early as 1253, was only granted city rights in 1926, after the Polish government began an effort to expand it as a port to rival Gdańsk, which had become an independent free city following the Treaty of Versailles.^[6]

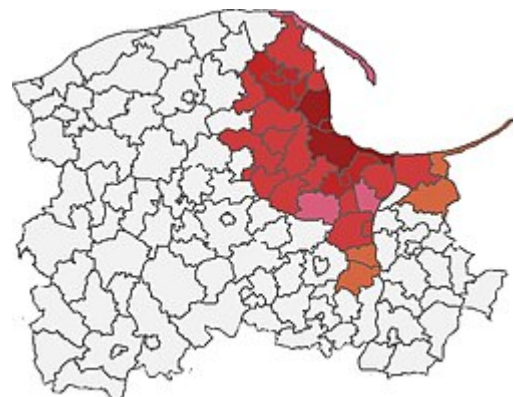
The first time the three settlements would find themselves under the same administration as cities occurred in 1939, following the invasion of Poland. They were all placed under the occupation of Nazi

Tricity Trójmiasto

Urban area



Clockwise from top: Gdańsk · Gdynia · Westerplatte Monument · Gdańsk Town Hall · Sea Towers · Polish Baltic Philharmonic · Pier in Sopot



A map of the Tricity agglomeration

Germany, which played a significant role in unifying and organizing the administrations of Gdańsk and Gdynia. In 1946, shortly after Poland retook all three cities, a nearly successful proposal was filed to unite them into one, though it ultimately failed. The first known mention of the Polish term *Trójmiasto* is found in a 1950 issue of *Dziennik Bałtycki*, a regional newspaper, and in the 1950s, various pan-Tricity organizations and publications were founded.^[1]

Geography



A forested area of the Tricity Landscape Park

Tricity is traditionally defined as consisting of the cities of Gdańsk, Sopot, and Gdynia;^[7] however, the broader metropolitan area also includes Tczew, Pruszcz Gdański, Kartuzy, Żukowo, Rumia, Wejherowo, Puck, Władysławowo, Jastarnia, and Hel. Gdańsk is at the core of Tricity, hosting most of its central administrative functions, but it is well-integrated with Gdynia and Sopot, as well as the other surrounding settlements. The area is located on the shore of Gdańsk Bay, a bay of the Baltic Sea.^[8]

Tricity, despite its seaside location, has varied terrain; Gdańsk is divided into two areas of higher and lower elevation referred to as the Upper Terrace (*Górny Taras*) and Lower Terrace (*Dolny Taras*) respectively,^[9] with the Upper Terrace reaching altitudes of up to 180 metres (590 ft), whereas the lowest point of the Lower Terrace is found at 1.6 metres (5.2 ft) below sea level.^[10]

Tricity is generally bounded by hilly terrain to the east, covered by the Tricity Landscape Park and found at the western edge of the elevated Kashubian Lake District. On the other hand, its coastal areas to the west have allowed for the formation of low-lying and accessible beaches, although some are still surrounded by extreme features such as the Orłowo Cliff.^[11]

Tricity has a total land area of approximately 2,077 km² (802 mi²), with broader definitions extending it to 4,157 km² (1,605 mi²).^[12]

	
Coordinates: 54°26′N 18°33′E	
Country Voivodeship	Poland Pomeranian
Government	
• Mayor of Gdańsk • Mayor of Gdynia • Mayor of Sopot	Aleksandra Dulciewicz Aleksandra Kosiorek Magdalena Czarzyńska-Jachim
Area	
• Total	2,077 km ² (802 sq mi)
Population (2024)	
• Total • Density	1,090,000 525/km² (1,360/sq mi)
Time zone • Summer (DST)	UTC+1 (CET) UTC+2 (CEST)
Area code	+48 058

Economy

Tricity, because of its favourable geographic position and infrastructure, is home to numerous companies, as well as large industrial and service sectors.^{[13][14]} The largest companies in Tricity include the energy company Energa, fashion company LPP, insurance company Ergo Hestia, the Polish branches of Viterra and Jysk, Remontowa and Gdańsk Shipyard, and the Polish branch of Intel.^[15]

Main sights

Notable attractions in Gdańsk include the Main City Hall, Artus Court, Neptune's Fountain, Uphagen's House, St. Mary's Church, Great Mill, Gdańsk Crane, European Solidarity Centre, Museum of the Second World War, and the National Museum.^[16] Attractions in Gdynia include the Emigration Museum, Kościuszko Square, the ships Dar Pomorza and ORP Błyskawica, and the Orłowo Cliff.^[17] The Sopot Pier, Sopot Lighthouse, Bohaterów Monte Cassino Street, and the Grand Hotel are among the attractions in Sopot.^[18]

Transport

Car transport

The S6 and S7 expressways go through or around Tricity;^[19] a part of the former is known as the Tricity Ring Road.^[20] As of 2007, 43.5% of commuters in Tricity went to work by car.^[12]

Rail transport

The Szybka Kolej Miejska (SKM), or the Rapid Urban Railway in English, is a commuter railway that primarily operates services in Rumia, Gdynia, Sopot, and Gdańsk; however, its network extends beyond these cities, as far as Tczew and Lębork.^[21] The Pomeranian Metropolitan Railway, opened in 2015,^[22] operates trains from Gdańsk Wrzeszcz via the airport to Gdynia Główna.^[21] Gdańsk Główny and Gdynia Główna both serve a large amount of national and international destinations, largely operated by PKP Intercity.^{[23][24]} In 2007, 12.8% of commuters in Tricity went to work by train, the largest such percentage among all other major agglomerations and metropolitan areas in Poland.^[12]

Buses

Gdańsk and Gdynia both have city bus networks. Gdańsk's bus system has 76 regular routes, 13 night routes, and 1 seasonal route,^[25] and operates in many surrounding towns and gminas, including Sopot.^[26] Gdynia's bus and trolleybus system has 79 regular routes, 9 express routes, and 7 night routes, also extending to the surrounding gminas and to Sopot.^[27] As of 2007, 32.6% of Tricity inhabitants commuted to work by bus.^[12]

Trams and trolleybuses

Gdańsk has a fully-developed tram system, with 11 lines and a total track length of 65 km (40 mi).^[28] As of 2007, 6.8% of Tricity inhabitants commuted to work by tram.^[12] Gdynia, on the other hand, has one of the few trolleybus systems in all of Poland, with 12 regular trolleybus routes in the city.^[27]



A Solaris Urbino 12 operated by the city public transport authority of Gdańsk

Air and sea connections

The principal airport of the Tricity area is Gdańsk Lech Wałęsa Airport, which has connections to cities and airports in several nations, primarily in Europe,^[29] and processed 6,714,149 passengers in total in 2024, as well as 11,681 t (12,876 short tons) of freight.^[30] Additionally, Stena Line operates ferries from Gdynia to Karlskrona,^[31] and Polferries operates a ferry service between Gdańsk and Nynäshamn.^[32] Żegluga Gdańska also operates voyages from Sopot, Gdynia, and Gdańsk to Hel, from central Gdańsk to Westerplatte, and from Gdynia to the Vistula Spit, as well as tours of the Port of Gdynia.^[33]

Sport

Lechia Gdańsk and Arka Gdynia are the central association football teams of each of their respective cities, competing against one another each year in the Tricity Derby.^[34] RC Lechia Gdańsk, Ogniwo Sopot, and RC Arka Gdynia, the rugby union teams for their respective cities, have all repeatedly been national champions in the sport.^[35] Wybrzeże Gdańsk is a historically very successful handball team^[36] and the basketball team Arka Gdynia has also seen repeated success in its respective discipline.^[37] Other notable teams include Trefl Gdańsk (volleyball)^[38] and Seahawks Gdynia (American football).^[39]

Politics

Gdańsk, Sopot, and Gdynia, all officially being considered cities under Polish law,^[40] function within the bounds of the officially outlined regulations and procedures of city governments.^[41] The mayor of Gdańsk is Aleksandra Dulkiewicz;^[42] the mayor of Gdynia is Aleksandra Kosiorek;^[43] and the mayor of Sopot is Magdalena Czarzyńska-Jachim.^[44] In the 2023 Polish parliamentary election, 46.67% of voters in Gdańsk voted for the Civic Coalition, 20.01% voted for Law and Justice, 14.47% voted for Trzecia Droga, and 10.97% voted for The Left.^[45] In Sopot, the percentages were 53.72% for the Civic Coalition, 20.46% for Law and Justice, 10.02% for Trzecia Droga, and 9.72% for The Left.^[46] In Gdynia, 46.74% voted for the Civic Coalition, 20.26% voted for Law and Justice, 13.66% voted for Trzecia Droga, and 11.25% voted for The Left.^[47]

Each of the cities of the Tricity is divided into districts (*dzielnice*). Gdańsk is subdivided into 36 (see Districts of Gdańsk), and the largest of them by population are Śródmieście, Przymorze Wielkie, Chełm, Wrzeszcz Dolny, and Wrzeszcz Górny.^[48] Gdynia has 21 districts, with the most